

For a QA/QC Consultancy interview, the biggest difference between a beginner and an experienced QA engineer is not knowing ISO 9001 clauses or definitions—it's understanding **what to check, what to approve, and what to reject**.

As a Consultant QA/QC Engineer, your primary responsibility is:

"Verify that the contractor's proposed materials, methods, drawings, and quality processes comply with the Contract Documents, Specifications, QCS, Approved Design, and Applicable Standards before work proceeds."

1. QA DOCUMENT REVIEW HIERARCHY

Review any submittal, follow this sequence:

Level 1: Contract Requirements

- Contract Drawings
- BOQ
- Particular Specifications

Level 2: Project Specifications

- Architectural Specification
- Civil Specification
- Structural Specification
- MEP Specification

Level 3: Codes & Standards

- QCS
- ASTM
- BS
- EN
- ISO
- NFPA
- QCDD Requirements (must)

2. MATERIAL SUBMITTAL REVIEW

What Consultant Checks

A. Compliance with Specification

Example: Tiles

Contract Requirement:

Porcelain Tile
Thickness = 10mm
Water Absorption <0.5%
PEI Class IV

Submitted Material:

Thickness = 8mm
Water Absorption = 2%

Result:

✗ Reject

Reason:

"Material does not comply with project specification requirements."

B. Technical Data Sheet

Check: details of the tiles

✓ Dimensions

- ✓ Finish
- ✓ Thickness
- ✓ Density
- ✓ Fire Rating
- ✓ Water Absorption
- ✓ Load Capacity
- ✓ Chemical Resistance

C. Test Certificates

Check:

- ASTM reports
- BS reports
- ISO reports

Verify:

- ✓ Valid
- ✓ Latest
- ✓ Accredited Laboratory

D. Manufacturer Approval

Check:

- Approved manufacturer list
- Approved vendor list

Material Submittal Checklist

Approve

- ✓ Meets specification
- ✓ Meets drawings
- ✓ Meets QCS

Conditional Approval

- ✓ Minor missing documents

Example:

"Approved subject to submission of color sample."

Reject

- ✗ Different material
- ✗ Wrong specification
- ✗ Missing test reports
- ✗ Unapproved manufacturer
- ✗ Does not comply with specs.

Interview Question

What would you check in a tile material submittal?

Answer:

1. Material specification compliance
2. Size of the tiles
3. Thickness
4. Water absorption
5. Slip resistance
6. Test certificates
7. Manufacturer approval
8. Color and finish
9. Compliance with approved mock-up

3. METHOD STATEMENT REVIEW

Most consultants reject method statements because contractors submit generic templates.

What To Check

A. Scope

Must clearly identify:

Installation of Metal Ceiling

B. References

Must include:

- Project Specification
- Approved Drawings
- QCS
- ASTM Standards

C. Resources

Check:

- Manpower
- Equipment
- Tools

Example:

Metal Ceiling:

- ✓ Laser level
- ✓ Mobile scaffold
- ✓ Safety (PPE)

D. Sequence of Work

Must be practical.

Example:

Wrong:

Install ceiling.

Correct:

1. Verify approved drawings
2. Verify MEP clearance
3. Mark grid lines
4. Install suspension system
5. Install carriers
6. Install ceiling panels
7. Openings for MEP services
8. Final inspection

E. Quality Control Section

Must include:

- H- Hold Points (Raising of inspection request is mandatory, work can't proceed with written approval of the consultant)
- W - Witness Points (Raising inspection is not mandatory, witnessing will be done with consultant to proceed with the work)
- S – Surveillance point (Ongoing monitoring to ensure work or material meets quality standards)
- R – Review (Document review only)

F. HSE Requirements

Check:

- Working at height
- PPE
- Electrical safety
- Lifting operations

Common Rejection Comments

"Method statement is generic and not project specific."

"Inspection sequence not adequately defined."

"Quality control procedures not indicated."

"HSE controls insufficient."

4. ITP REVIEW

This is one of the most important consultancy activities.

What Consultant Checks

Activity

Example:

Gypsum Ceiling Installation

Inspection Stage

Must contain:

Activity	Inspection
Material Delivery	Verify material
Grid Installation	Alignment
Ceiling Panel Installation	Finish
Final Inspection	Acceptance

Acceptance Criteria

Should refer to:

- Specification section
- Approved drawings
- QCS

Hold Points

Example:

HP-01

Inspection before ceiling closure

No work proceeds without consultant approval.

Witness Points

Consultant may attend.

Common Rejections

- ✗ No hold points
- ✗ No acceptance criteria
- ✗ References missing
- ✗ Responsibilities unclear

5. PROJECT QUALITY PLAN (PQP)

This document tells you:

How contractor manages quality

Review Checklist

Organization Chart

Check:

- Project Manager
- QA Manager
- QA/QC Engineer
- Inspectors

Procedures

Must include:

- ✓ Material Control
- ✓ NCR Control
- ✓ Calibration
- ✓ Inspection Process
- ✓ Document Control

Quality Objectives

Example:

NCR less than 2%

Inspection approval rate >95%

Records

Check:

- IR
- MIR
- WIR
- NCR

Common Rejections

- ✗ Generic corporate plan
- ✗ No project-specific procedures
- ✗ Missing responsibilities

6. HSE PLAN REVIEW

Consultant checks:

Risk Assessment

Must cover:

- Working at height
- Hot work
- Confined space
- Lifting operations

Emergency Procedures

- Fire
- Medical
- Evacuation

Training Matrix

Must show:

- First aid
- Scaffold training
- Lifting training

Permit System

Check:

- ✓ Hot work permit
- ✓ Electrical permit
- ✓ Excavation permit
- ✓ Confined Space permit

Common Rejection

"Risk assessment not covering project activities."

7. PREQUALIFICATION SUBMITTAL REVIEW

Used for subcontractor approval.

Check

Company Profile

Years of experience

Similar Projects

Check:

- Hotels
- Towers
- Hospitals

Similar scope is important.

Financial Capability

- Turnover
- Bank references

Resources

- Engineers
- Supervisors
- Skilled workers

QA/QC Capability

- ISO 9001
- QA team

Common Rejection

"No evidence of similar project experience."

8. SHOP DRAWING REVIEW

Golden Rule

You are NOT checking drafting quality.

You are checking:

Compliance

Example

Architectural Drawing

Door:
900x2400 mm
Fire Rated 60 min
Shop Drawing:
900x2100 mm
Reject.

Check 1

Specification compliance

Check 2

Architectural compliance

Check 3

Structural coordination

Example:

Anchor fixed into post-tension slab.

Need structural approval.

Check 4

MEP coordination

Example:

Ceiling access panel blocked by duct.

Reject.

Check 5

Buildability

Can it actually be installed?

Common Review Comments

"Provide coordination with ceiling services."

"Dimension not matching IFC drawings."

"Provide fixing details."

"Provide section details."

9. CONSULTANT SUBMITTAL WORKFLOW

Contractor



Submit Document



Document Controller



QA/QC Review



Discipline Engineer Review



Consultant Comments



A = Approved

B = Approved with Comments

C = Revise & Resubmit

D = Rejected
↓
Contractor Action
↓
Resubmission
↓
Final Approval

PRACTICAL INTERVIEW SCENARIO

"A contractor submits marble cladding material. How do you review it?"

Answer:

1. Check specification requirements.
2. Verify approved manufacturer.
3. Review TDS.
4. Verify thickness and finish.
5. Check the visuals (if available)
6. Check physical properties.
7. Review test certificates.
8. Verify fire and safety requirements.
9. Check sample approval.
10. Verify compatibility with fixing system.
11. Approve, conditionally approve, or reject with comments.

"What is the difference between QA and QC?"

QA (Preventive)

- PQP
- Method Statement
- ITP
- Audits
- Procedures

QC (Detection)

- Material Inspection
- Site Inspection
- Testing
- NCRs
- Punch Lists

Material Inspection at site

- Check the approved material submittal
- Check the sample (if provided and approved)
- Check the Delivery date
- Check the Manufacturer recommendations and QCS for storage of materials
- Check the Quantity delivered at site matching with the delivery note attached
- Check the material is not damaged and delivered in good condition

Work Inspection

- Approved shop drawing attached

- Approved method statement cover attached
- Hold point/Inspection stage in the ITP
- Previous activity's approved inspection attached
- Work done at site as per the approved shop drawing
- Finish of the work meets the quality standard and project specs.
- Approved methodology used for the execution of the work
- MEP clearance attached (if required) ex. For ceiling closure inspection, MEP clearance is required

Approved – No comments (work done as per requirements and attachments)

Approved as Noted – Minor comments to be rectified and can proceed with the next activity

Revise & Resubmit – Work not accepted, work not done as per attachments, Not complied with quality standards